

NEO ZHANG

GAME DESIGNER

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SKILLS

Engines: UE5, Unity, Godot

Scripting Languages: C#, C++, Python, UE5 Blueprint

Misc Tools: Miro, Visual Studio, Figma, Jira, Blender, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office, Git

Languages: English & Mandarin Chinese (Fluent)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Combat & System Designer | Unity + Proprietary Tools | Jan 2026 – Present

Shadowstone (PC Early Access) | 3D Co-op Tactics RPG Roguelite

- Defined, pitched, and implemented Shadowstone's core combat system and enemy/biome design ruleset, creating systemic interactions that generate fresh tactical situations every round and every run.
- Designed opt-in escalation systems where player choice, not skill, drives late-game difficulty, preserving the core loop while keeping new content relevant across runs.
- Owned 30+ enemies across 4 archetypes and 5 boss encounters end-to-end, from concept and implementation through iteration and balance.
- Shipped content and balance patches on a 5-week cadence driven by live telemetry and player feedback, increasing runs per player by 59%.
- Established a cross-discipline enemy production pipeline with Engineering, Art, UX, and QA, cutting hand-off clarification requests by 60%.

Level & Narrative Designer | Unity + Proprietary Tools | Oct 2023 – May 2026

Sunderfolk + DLC (PC / Xbox / PS5 / Switch) | 3D Co-op Tactics RPG

- Designed co-op systems for a phone-as-controller, shared-screen format, making tactical play accessible to both core and casual players without sacrificing strategic depth.
- Partnered with the Game Director to design and implement DLC (worldbuilding, new hero, scope/budget), driving a 17% sales increase and doubling daily active players.
- Led design of 10 missions from paper concept and blockout through iteration and ship, each built around a distinct feature (puzzle, combat, exploration) that encourages cooperative strategy.
- Owned 10 characters end-to-end (1 playable hero, 4 bosses, 5 enemies), designing ability kits from each character's fantasy and balancing the hero against the full roster for co-op play.
- Co-led creative direction and implementation of 30+ cinematic cutscenes, from script and storyboard through in-engine assembly.
- Wrote and implemented 75% of the game's narrative content, including NPC dialogue, tutorials, and barks.
- Ran 3 playtests per week, turning feedback and edge cases into fast design iterations.

Design Officer & Engineer | Unity and UE4 | Sep 2019 – Jul 2023

- Mentored 35+ student designers over 4 years, running 10 workshops annually on design fundamentals, team workflow, and cross-discipline collaboration.
- Built UE4 and Unity editor tools (cutscene builder, ability creator, level editor) that let designers, artists, and writers create content independently, cutting creation time by 68%.

EDUCATION

B.S. in Computer Science & Game Design | University of California, Santa Cruz | 2019 – 2023